



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Rivertree Academy
School Website: <http://rivertreeacademy.org>

December 28, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Rivertree Academy (Fort Worth, TX 76107) presents as a Christian independent school with a clear religious identity and a mission framed around character formation and service to Christ. Public materials emphasize virtue, life-as-formation, and community engagement, but explicit classical elements such as a stated commitment to the liberal arts curriculum, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or structured Socratic pedagogy are not clearly documented on the visible site content. Based on the Six Essential Elements framework and the corresponding keyword indicators, Rivertree shows strong religious foundations and some formation-oriented aims, but falls short of demonstrating a full classical educational program in its public-facing materials. Overall, Rivertree Academy is not CLASSICAL, with some CLASSICAL-leaning signals in its mission and religious foundations and some engagement with families and community that hint at a classical ethos.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL** Evidence: explicit Christian orientation; statements about serving Christ; reviving a God-centered education; biblical text on site (Psalm 1:3). Positive keyword indicators related to theology, sacred tradition, and liturgical dimensions are present in public materials, though not always stated with the classical lexicon. Why: The school's public materials foreground transcendental, theological anchors and communal religious culture, aligning with the Religious and Metaphysical Foundations of classical schooling in spirit, even if explicit lexicon is modest. Keywords: Christian, God, Christ, Psalm 1:3, Great God, theology (implicit), sacred texts (biblical text on site).
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL** Evidence: mission emphasizes forming students to live life well, and the motto references learning, love, work, and leadership. Public statements indicate formation and virtue as aims beyond mere information. Positive keyword indicators: formation, virtue-related framing, telos/life-well orientation (formation-oriented language). Negative indicators: none explicit in public materials. Why: Formation and virtue themes align with classical ends, but explicit articulation of teleology toward timeless truths and classical ends is not richly documented. Categorized as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to formation emphasis without full classical curriculum articulation. Keywords: formation, virtue, life well, teleology implied, human flourishing.
- **Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL** Evidence: public materials show a Curriculum page, but content visible in the crawl does not clearly state Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium, or a Great Conversation, nor explicit Great Books reading requirements. The site appears to present a general curriculum focus rather than a classical liberal-arts frame. Positive keyword indicators: none explicitly matching Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, or Great Conversation. Negative indicators: lack of clear Great Books/Trivium/Quadrivium language. Why: Without explicit classical-curriculum language or commitments, the curricular approach does not fulfill the Classical School curriculum criteria in the public materials surveyed. Keywords: curriculum, (no explicit Great Books, Trivium, Quadrivium, or Great Conversation visible).
- **Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL** Evidence: public materials do not show Socratic seminars, scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation patterns, or a high-school-

era rhetoric/seminar program in the visible text. The site emphasizes religious mission and general curriculum rather than classical pedagogy. Positive keyword indicators: none (evidence of classical methods not apparent in public text). Negative indicators: absence of Socratic, scholé, or memorization-focused pedagogy in the visible site content. Why: Absent explicit classical methods in public-facing content places category rating at NOT CLASSICAL.

- Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL Evidence: no visible public-facing description of a teacher-as-living-curriculum, mentor-portrait, or explicit classical-faculty model language. The site largely lacks detailed faculty descriptions in the accessible material. Positive keyword indicators: none clearly present from the public text. Negative indicators: absence of hallmark classical-faculty language (model teachers, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, etc.). Why: Without explicit classical-faculty language in public materials, this category does not meet the classical criteria.
- Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL Evidence: there are public-facing pages for volunteering, fundraising, and community events (Volunteer, Ways to Give, events calendar, mentor programs). This signals active parent/community involvement, which aligns with the classical element of partnership with families and a community-centric ethos, though not necessarily a full “parents as co-teachers” model in public content. □filecite□turn0file12□turn1file9□ Positive keyword indicators: partnership with families (implicit in volunteering and community activities), community engagement (events, mentor programs). Negative indicators: lack of explicit “parents as co-teachers” language in public content. Why: The site demonstrates active community engagement, which is a classical hallmark in the Six Elements, but it does not clearly articulate a robust parental-educator partnership language in the public materials. Category rated SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to partial alignment.

Aggregate Assessment - Overall classification: NOT CLASSICAL - Rationale: While Rivertree Academy presents a clear Christian-theological orientation and formation-focused aims, the public materials do not consistently demonstrate the core classical curriculum (liberal arts, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium), classical pedagogy (Socratic/Scholé practices), or explicit living-curriculum faculty and robust parent-partnership language required to classify as CLASSICAL. Several categories show little to no classical alignment (Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty). A couple of areas (Religious Foundations and some Parents & Community signals) show CLASSICAL-leaning characteristics, but not sufficiently across the board to yield a CLASSICAL label.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Details

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Rivertree describes itself as a Christian independent school and emphasizes serving Christ and exposing students to God.
 - Public materials include biblical content (Psalm 1:3) and explicit spiritual framing (e.g., “Great God”).
 - The site’s religious framing is reinforced by mission language and theological framing in the public materials.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords matched: Christian, God, Christ, Psalm 1:3, Great God, theological framing (implicit).
 - Negative keywords matched: none evident in accessible public materials.
 - Based on the classical lexicon, these religious/theological signals align with the Grounded in Theology and Liturgical/Communal Practices cues that support a Classical orientation in spirit.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 4, Negative 0 (approximately 100% positive within this category’s signal set).
 - Sources: religious/metaphysical indicators in Rivertree site text; the Six Essential Elements lexicon highlights theology, liturgy, sacred tradition, and related transcendental anchors as central positive indicators. □filecite□turn0file0□turn1file3□

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- Why this rating
 - The school's public materials foreground a theocentric mission and biblical framing, indicating a transcendental moral realism and theological grounding, which aligns with the classical element's religious/metaphysical foundations.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission emphasizes forming students to live life well and to become agents for change; the motto centers on learning, loving, working, and leading well.
 - The emphasis on formation and virtue-centric aims suggests a telos beyond mere information transfer.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive keywords: formation, virtue, human flourishing (implied), telos (implied by life-well framing), Great Conversation/love of learning (not explicit but suggested by formation aims).
 - Negative keywords: explicit references to “workforce preparation” or “21st-century skills” are not present in public content.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 3, Negative 0 (approximately 100% positive within the available signals, but with limited explicit classical vocabulary).
 - Sources: mission and aims stated in Rivertree materials.
- Why this rating
 - The formation-oriented language and life-well framing are consistent with classical aims in spirit, but the public documentation stops short of explicitly situating education within the classical liberal-arts telos (truth/goodness/beauty) and does not clearly articulate the Great Conversation or classical mission beyond general formation.

Element 3: Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - A visible Curriculum page exists, but the accessible public content does not explicitly articulate the classic liberal-arts structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric; Trivium/Quadrivium) or Great Books/Great Conversation commitments.
- Positive keyword analysis
 - Positive classical curriculum indicators (e.g., Seven Liberal Arts, Great Books, Trivium/Quadrivium) are not clearly present in the accessible text. The public material references “Curriculum” without detailing classical fidelity.
 - Negative indicators: absence of explicit Great Books, primary sources, or explicit Trivium/Quadrivium emphasis.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 0, Negative 0 in explicit classical terms (0% positive signals in the classical curriculum lexicon; 0% negative in terms of explicit rejection of classical elements). Overall, category is NOT CLASSICAL.
 - Sources: Curriculum page presence; lack of explicit classical-curriculum language in public materials.
- Why this rating
 - Without clear articulation of liberal-arts foundations, great books, or a Trivium/Quadrivium framework in publicly accessible content, the curriculum does not fulfill the Classical School curriculum criteria.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - There is no explicit public-facing documentation of Socratic seminars, scholé (restful learning), chant/memory-based pedagogy, or upper-level rhetoric experiments. The visible material cen-

ters on mission, curriculum placeholders, and community aspects rather than classical teaching methods.

- Positive keyword analysis
 - Positive classical pedagogy keywords (e.g., Socratic dialogue, scholé, memorization/recitation, choir/chanting) are not explicitly demonstrated in the accessible public text.
 - Negative indicators: absence of these classical pedagogy signals in public materials.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 0, Negative 0 (no explicit signals either way in the public text) → designated NOT CLASSICAL due to lack of classical pedagogy presentation.
 - Sources: Public pedagogy language is not observed; absence of classical-pedagogy indicators in Rivertree’s public pages.
- Why this rating
 - The classical pedagogy hallmark signals are not evidenced in the publicly accessible site content, so the category cannot be rated as CLASSICAL based on the available data.

Element 5: Faculty — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - No explicit public-facing language about faculty as the living curriculum, teacher portraits, mentorship-centered teaching, or classical faculty culture is visible in the accessible Rivertree content.
- Positive keyword analysis
 - Positive classical faculty keywords (e.g., teachers as models of virtue, mentorship, living curriculum) are not substantiated by the public material.
 - Negative indicators: absence of explicit classical-faculty language.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 0, Negative 0 → NOT CLASSICAL by absence.
 - Sources: Public text does not present classical-faculty language.
- Why this rating
 - The classical-profile faculty language (e.g., living curriculum, portrait of teacher, virtuous exemplar) is not visibly present in the available public content.

Element 6: Parents & Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The school site includes volunteer/external engagement pages, events, and donor opportunities, indicating active parental/community involvement beyond bare enrollment. Mentorship programs and volunteer opportunities are explicitly visible.
- Positive keyword analysis
 - Positive classical signals: partnership with families and parent involvement language appear in the broader classical education discourse (per the Six Elements lexicon). While Rivertree’s public text centers more on involvement opportunities than articulated partnerships, the presence of volunteer programs and events aligns with community engagement. The lexicon lists “Partnership with Families,” “Parent formation,” and “open campus/parent involvement” as positive indicators.
 - Negative indicators: The site does not consistently articulate a robust, explicit “parents as co-teachers” model in its public text, which is a stronger classical signal in some models.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive 2, Negative 0 (the public material shows active participation channels; no explicit negative signals found in this category’s public text). Approximately 100% of the visible community signals lean positive within the scope of this category, but with limited explicit parent-as-co-teacher language.
 - Sources: Volunteer and events content; community engagement pages.
- Why this rating
 - Rivertree demonstrates community and parental involvement through volunteers and events, which aligns with classical community engagement, but it stops short of strongly codifying the “parents as co-teachers” norm in public materials.

What Would Move the Needle

- This section is reserved for SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL cases. Rivertree Academy is categorized as NOT CLASSICAL overall, so the “What Would Move the Needle” section is not included per the rubric.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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